

Installing the Red Hat Identity Management Server

Computer security is best achieved by allowing access to authorised users only. Red Hat Identity Management is a means of centrally setting up the authorisation and management of identities. The Red Hat IdM solution is native to RHEL from Linux version 6.3 onwards. This article lists the various steps needed to install the Red Hat Identity Management server.



Red Hat Identity Management (IdM) is a solution for centrally managing the authentication of identities and authorisation policies from a Linux server, for enrolled Linux clients, using native Linux tools. Red Hat IdM v2.2 was first introduced in Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) 6.3. An upgrade to Red Hat IdM v3.0 occurred with RHEL 6.4.

Based on the Free IPA project (Identity, Policy, Audit), a Red Hat Identity Management domain consists of a number of services. The 389 Directory Server is the main data store using LDAPv3 (Lightweight Directory Access Protocol) single sign-on authentication and it is provided by an MIT Kerberos KDC (Key Distribution Center). An integrated certificate system is based on the Dogtag project. Synchronised time can be provided by an integrated NTP service. Optionally, DNS services and registration can be managed with an integrated ISC BIND service.

The ipa-server and ipa-client packages install the various packages for the above services and dependencies. The project features simple installation scripts (ipa-server-install and ipa-client-install) for both the server and client that can be run interactively or with options unattended to configure all the services. Administration can be done from either a Web-

based user interface (from ipa-server) or a command line utility (from ipa-admin tools installed on a client).

Other features include configuring multiple Red Hat IdM servers in a single domain to provide replication, redundancy and stability. It also supports synchronisation of data (or trust) with an Active Directory forest to preserve a centralised user store, but should not be seen as an AD (Active Directory) replacement.

An IdM client is any machine that can retrieve credentials from an IdM server. SSSD (System Security Services Daemon) provides for keytab retrieval, offering user authentication and enforcing host based access control rules (the identity and policy parts). Certmonger monitors and renews the certificates on the client.

When a host is enrolled as an IdM client, SSSD and Certmonger are reconfigured to point to the IdM server for the keytab, and host certificates are created. Technically, IdM does not use the host certificate directly, but it may be used by other services.

Steps for installing the IdM server

1. Perform the required steps by reviewing the hardware and software prerequisites, opening the necessary ports in the firewall, and confirming the network and system's configuration.